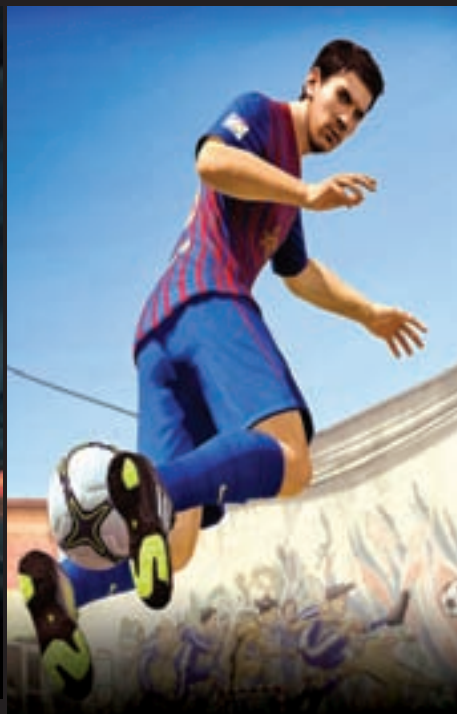




Epic games of the month

Mass Effect 3

The final chapter in the *Mass Effect* series featuring Shepard is one of the most hotly anticipated RPGs to be releasing this year. The game features a vastly improved combat system and is supposed to provide a fun and action-packed third person shooter experience, coupled with the depth and complexity of a true RPG. Bioware has worked overtime on this game and had in fact started development even before *Mass Effect 2* was released. Many of the pivotal characters of *ME2* – including Liara and Kaidan – are making a comeback, and the game now finally includes femshep! Who is femshep? The female version of Commander Shepard of course (as the fans call her).

The developers have gone through great pains to ensure that the fans of the series are well rewarded for their troubles. Those with saves from the previous game in the series can use these saves to influence the outcome of certain conversations, as well as the entire final chapter. The game also includes an “action” and a “story” mode alongside the normal mode, giving players a chance to play the game the way they want to. This game looks like it's going to be one hell of a ride. Time to start polishing your controllers.

FIFA Street

All of you waiting for a *FIFA Street* game since the past four years, your agonizing wait will soon be over. In fact, later this month – no need to look at the calendar. The shiny new *FIFA Street* will obviously be better than all previous titles. But how much better? Will it really be worth your money (and the four years of waiting time)? You betcha!

From what we know, the game's based on the revamped *FIFA 12* engine (we all loved it, didn't we now?) and gets rid of all cartoony-player profiles. Authenticity is the name of the game in *FIFA Street*, and EA couldn't emphasise it any better. Especially when it has a person like Gary Paterson, himself a street football fan, in charge of the *FIFA* franchise.

Apart from improved street locations, the game features an exhaustive array of street soccer teams from around the world. The game will allow you to enact twice the number of trick shots than in the previous version, not to mention a new attacking system and a whole bunch of skills to keep you hooked. If all that wasn't enough, online gameplay will ensure you never leave the house on weekends. So yeah, later this month, it will be time to put on your game shoes.

Resident Evil: Operation Raccoon city

Another blockbuster game releasing this month, *Operation Raccoon City*, is part of the long-running *Resident Evil* franchise. We managed to get our hands on the game at a sneak preview, courtesy Milestone Interactive and we must say, the in-game graphics were quite impressive on the PS3. Fast-paced and hectic, the combat never lets up. Action-packed from the word go, multi-player is engaging and fun and from what we could gauge, the game seems to have a lot of replay value.

Operation Raccoon City is set during the events of *Resident Evil 2* and *3*. In an interesting new twist to the series, you can now play as Umbrella Corp. assassins and can even decide whether you want to kill off the main protagonists in the original storyline. The game also features some new and interesting multi-player modes, a unique aspect of which is that if you get into a fight with a zombie, you'll actually get infected, die and turn into a zombie yourself – at least until you're shot in the head.

The game introduces “bleeding”, which means that the player's screen turns red and s/he becomes a larger target for the zombie horde! What could be more fun?*